

DOCUMENTATION OF LATILONG PAPE BIRD SIGHTING
FOR
THE COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS' RECORDS

56-95-101

Accepted (7-1)

Species: Purple Finch
(Vernacular name)

Carduelis purpureus
(Scientific name)

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students--those studying occurrences 50 years from now--must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

PHOTO

Date (s): 6 Nov 95 Time Bird Seen: 10:30 to 11:15

Locality: Boulder, Boulder County, Colorado
Nearest town, county and state:

Optical equipment: 8x24 binoculars; Bushnell spotting scope

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used: Nikon 600 mm lens;

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: Male Plumage: _____

Light conditions: Sunny

Distance from bird, and how measured: approx 25 feet (distance from tree branch to house)

Describe the bird's overall behavior:

perched on branch of ash tree outside back window in yard. Feeder was nearby. Sat mostly in the tree on various branches. Came to feeder infrequently, mostly to ground below it.

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird:

~~are~~ backyard on one acre lot, many trees in neighborhood, north edge of town

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

none

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of bill, wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions is not enough.) Describe what you actually saw in the field.

The bird had an overall rosy appearance, in stark contrast to the numerous house finches in the yard. No matter which way it turned the rosy color showed through. I was struck by this feature & got out camera & tripod & 600 mm lens to photograph it.

The bird appeared identical to house finch in size, shape, & beak. It was cooperative enough that I got 5 shots while standing in the doorway.

Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery-- i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.: Didn't hear any calls.

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

House finch — male & female are in yard every day at feeder. Noticeable difference

Cassin's finch — harder to eliminate. But back of bird's head was rosy. The rump was not brown. Rosy color showed through wings. Rump was rosy. Breast toward belly was mottled rosy & white — no sharp streaking. The 5 slides were examined by experienced birders.

Prior experience with this and similar species:

Never saw this bird before. But have seen & photographed both Cassin's & House finch.

This report was written from notes made during ___ after ☒ observation; from memory ☒ ^{and}

NAME (print): Richard Holmes

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Signature: Richard Holmes

Return Form To: CFO Records Committee
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Denver Museum of Natural History
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